

Word family: **run / runs / ran / run / running / runner**

Base word: run

Past tense: ran

Past participle: run

ing form: running

Related forms: runner, running

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At present, I still **run into** him from time to time...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **run into** means to **meet someone unexpectedly or by chance**, without having arranged to see them.

The speaker means that he still occasionally happens to meet Mr. Wong.

繁體中文： **沒有預先約定或安排，而是偶然、碰巧遇見某人**

中文翻譯：

> “At present, I still **run into** him from time to time...”

「直到現在，我偶爾還是會**碰巧遇到 / 偶遇**他……」

Here:

run into someone = 偶然遇到某人；碰巧碰見某人

Because **run into** is essential to the exact sentence, it should be treated explicitly even though the Golden Manual normally excludes phrasal verbs unless the target sentence requires them.

1. **run = move quickly on foot (人物 / 動物) — 跑；奔跑**

This is the basic physical meaning.

Meaning: To move quickly on foot, with both feet sometimes off the ground.

Practice 1

> “She **ran** to the station because she was late.”

「她因為遲到而**跑去車站**。」

Practice 2

> “The children were **running** around the park.”

「孩子們正在公園裡四處**跑**。」

****run = 用雙腳快速移動，速度通常比走路快****

Common:

- * run home
- * run to school
- * run across the road
- * run fast
- * run a marathon

These belong to one physical-movement sense.

2. ****run = operate/function (機器 / 系統) — 運作；運行****

A machine, engine, program, or system can ****run**** when it is operating.

Practice 3

> “The engine is still **running**.”

「引擎仍然在**運轉**。」

Practice 4

> “This program ****runs**** automatically every morning.”

「這個程式每天早上都會自動****運行****。」

****run = 機器、設備、程式或系統處於正常操作和運作狀態****

Common:

- * engine runs
- * machine runs
- * software runs

* system runs

This is genuinely different from physical running.

3. **run + business/organization/project (管理 / 經營) — 經營 ; 管理 ; 主持**

Here, **run** means to be responsible for controlling or organizing something.

Practice 5

> “She **runs** a small café near the station.”

「她在車站附近**經營**一間小咖啡店。」

Practice 6

> “He was asked to **run** the project.”

「他被要求**負責管理 / 主持**這個項目。」

run something = 負責管理、經營、安排或控制某個機構、業務、活動或項目

Common:

* run a company

* run a shop

* run a department

* run a project

* run an event

These are one management sense.

4. **run + activity/test/program/process (進行 / 執行) — 進行 ; 執行**

Run can mean carrying out an organized process, test, experiment, campaign, course, etc.

Practice 7

> “The researchers **ran** several tests.”

「研究人員**進行了**幾項測試。」

Practice 8

> “The school **runs** evening classes for adults.”

「這間學校為成年人**開辦 / 舉辦**夜間課程。」

run something = 按照安排把某個活動、測試、課程或程序實際進行

This is related to the management sense, but the focus here is:

> **carry out / conduct**

rather than:

> **be responsible for an organization**

I would keep it explicit because learners encounter it constantly.

5. **run** = continue/extend over time or distance (時間 / 距離) — 持續 ; 延伸

A road, event, programme, contract, exhibition, etc. can **run** for a period or across a distance.

Practice 9

> “The exhibition **runs** until the end of the month.”

「這個展覽會**持續至**月底。」

Practice 10

> “The road **runs** along the coast.”

「這條道路**沿着**海岸**延伸**。」

run = 某件事情在時間上持續，或某條線、道路、邊界等在空間上延伸

The exact Chinese changes:

* event runs → 持續

* road runs → 延伸

* boundary runs → 延伸 / 沿着

But the broader concept is:

> **extend continuously**

6. **run = flow (液體) — 流 ; 流動**

Liquids can **run** when they flow.

Practice 11

> “Water was **running** down the wall.”

「水正沿着牆壁**流下來**。」

Practice 12

> “Tears **ran** down her face.”

「眼淚沿着她的臉頰**流下**。」

****run = 液體連續地向某個方向流動****

Common:

* water runs

* tears run

* blood runs

* paint runs

This is a separate physical process from a person running.

7. **run = become/change into a condition (顏色 / 狀態) — 變成 ; 變得**

In some established combinations, **run** describes entering a particular condition.

Practice 13

> “The river **ran dry** during the drought.”

「旱災期間，河流**乾涸了**。」

Practice 14

> “His face **ran red** with embarrassment.”

「他因尷尬而臉色**變紅**。」

****run + adjective/state = 逐漸或明顯地進入某種狀態****

This use is collocational and should not be generalized freely to every adjective.

8. ****run = be a candidate in an election (選舉) — 參選 ; 競選****

In political and organizational contexts, ****run**** can mean becoming a candidate for an elected position.

Practice 15

> “She decided to ****run for mayor****.”

「她決定****參選市長****。」

Practice 16

> “Three people are ****running for**** the position.”

「有三個人正在****競逐這個職位****。」

****run for + elected position = 正式參加選舉 , 爭取某個職位****

This is a distinct established use.

9. ****run = publish/broadcast/show (媒體 / 廣告 / 節目) — 刊登 ; 播放 ; 播出****

Media can ****run**** a story, advertisement, programme, etc.

Practice 17

> “The newspaper ****ran**** the story on its front page.”

「報紙在頭版****刊登了****這則新聞。」

Practice 18

> “The channel ****ran**** the documentary again last night.”

「電視頻道昨晚再次**播放了**這部紀錄片。」

****run + story/ad/programme = 媒體把某項內容刊登、播放或公開呈現****

This is common enough in media English to deserve its own entry.

10. ****run = transport service operates (交通) — 行駛；營運****

A train, bus, ferry, etc. can ****run**** when it operates according to a service.

Practice 19

> “The last train ****runs**** at midnight.”

「最後一班火車在午夜**開出 / 行駛**。」

Practice 20

> “Buses ****run**** every ten minutes.”

「巴士每十分鐘**行駛一班**。」

****run = 公共交通服務按照時間表行駛或營運****

This could be seen as a transport-specific branch of the broader ****operate/function**** sense.

For database counting, I would merge it with Meaning 2 rather than artificially separate it.

Target construction: ****run into someone — 偶遇；碰見****

This is the exact use in your passage.

Practice 21 — Original

> “At present, I still ****run into**** him from time to time.”

「直到現在，我偶爾還是會**碰巧遇到他**。」

Practice 22

> “I ****ran into**** an old classmate at the station.”

「我在車站**偶然遇到**一位舊同學。」

Practice 23

> “She **ran into** her former manager while shopping.”

「她購物時**碰巧遇見**以前的經理。」

run into someone = 沒有預先安排，而是在某個地方偶然遇見某人

This is a phrasal verb and should be treated as a target-specific extension rather than another bare **run** sense.

Another common construction: **run into + problem/difficulty (遇上問題) — 遇到；碰上**

The same phrasal verb can also apply to difficulties.

Practice 24

> “We **ran into** several technical problems.”

「我們**遇到**了幾個技術問題。」

Practice 25

> “The project **ran into** financial difficulties.”

「這個項目**遇上了**財務困難。」

run into a problem = 意外遇到或開始面對某個問題、困難或障礙

This is figuratively related to:

> unexpectedly encounter something

So within **run into**, I would keep **person** and **problem** as two useful contextual branches, but not necessarily treat them as unrelated lexical senses.

Related form: **runner**

The most basic meaning of **runner** is a person who runs.

Practice 26

> “She is a long-distance **runner**.”

「她是一名長跑**跑手** / 跑步運動員。」

Practice 27

> “The fastest **runner** finished in under ten minutes.”

「最快的**跑手**在十分鐘內完成。」

runner = 以跑步為運動、比賽或活動的人

However, **runner** itself has several other meanings—such as a long narrow strip of carpet or a plant shoot—so it could justify its own separate polysemy entry if needed.

Related form: **running**

Running can mean the activity of running:

> “**Running** is good exercise.”

「**跑步**是一種很好的運動。」

It also appears adjectivally:

> **running water** = 流動的水 / 自來水

> **running cost** = 持續營運成本

> **running total** = 累計總數

Because **running** has many useful extensions, it should be treated as a family member rather than automatically adding each collocation to the core **run** count.

Important distinction: **run** vs **operate**

run

can mean either:

* something operates;

* or someone operates/manages something.

> “The machine is running.”

> “She runs the machine.”

operate

is more formal/technical and can similarly be intransitive or transitive.

But **run** has many broader everyday meanings that **operate** does not.

Important distinction: **run vs manage**

run a business

and:

> **manage a business**

can overlap.

But **run** often suggests overall responsibility for the operation.

Manage can refer to handling only one part or level of it.

> “She runs the company.”

may imply she controls the organization overall.

> “She manages one department.”

may refer to a narrower responsibility.

Important distinction: **run vs walk**

run

= move quickly on foot

walk

= move at a normal pace while keeping at least one foot on the ground

This is the basic physical contrast.

Important distinction: **run** vs **flow**

For liquids:

run

is very natural in everyday descriptions:

> “Water ran down the wall.”

flow

is more general and often more neutral/formal:

> “Water flowed through the pipe.”

Both describe continuous movement of liquid, but **run** has a wider set of everyday figurative uses.

Important distinction: **run** vs **stand for election**

Both can mean becoming a candidate.

run for office

is especially common in American English.

stand for election

is especially common in British English.

The political meaning is the same broad concept:

> **be a candidate**

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **run**
* **runs**
* **ran**
* **running**
* **runner**

Useful constructions and compounds include:

* run a company
* run a test
* run software
* run for office
* run dry
* running water
* running costs
* runner
* run into

Because **run** is extraordinarily polysemous, the Golden Manual's merging test is especially important: contexts that merely change the object should remain together when the same broad semantic idea still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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run — move quickly on foot	用雙腳快速移動，速度通常比走路快
run — machine/system operates	機器、設備、程式或系統處於正常操作和運作狀態
run + business/organization/project	負責管理、經營、安排或控制某個機構、業務或項目
run + test/activity/process	按照安排把某個測試、活動、課程或程序實際進行
run — extend/continue	某件事情在時間上持續，或某條道路、線、邊界等在空間上延伸
run — liquid flows	液體連續地向某個方向流動
run + state/adjective	在固定搭配中進入某種狀態，例如 run dry
run for office/election	正式參加選舉，爭取某個職位
run + media content	報紙、網站、電視台等刊登、播放或公開呈現某項內容
run into someone	沒有預先安排，而是在某個地方偶然遇見某人
run into a problem	意外遇到或開始面對某個問題、困難或障礙
runner	以跑步為運動、比賽或主要活動的人

For your original sentence

> “At present, I still **run into** him from time to time...”

The exact meaning is:

run into someone = 沒有預先安排或約定，而是偶然碰見某人

So:

> **I still run into him from time to time**

= **我現在偶爾還是會碰巧遇到他**

For your database, I would count **8** genuinely useful core meanings of bare **run**:

1. **move quickly on foot**
2. **operate/function — machine, system, software**
3. **manage/control — run a business/project**
4. **conduct/carry out — run a test/activity/program**
5. **continue or extend over time/distance**
6. **flow — liquid**
7. **enter a state in fixed combinations — run dry, run cold, etc.**
8. **be a candidate — run for election/office**
9. **media — publish/broadcast/show content**

That is actually **9** core meanings if we keep the media sense separate.

Then I would keep **run into someone / run into a problem** as the **target phrasal-verb extension**, rather than count it as another bare **run** meaning.